

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 16: Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	16 — Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: confusing Mahmud's loot-and-leave raiding (~17 raids, withdrew each time) with the Ghurids' staying-to-govern; reversing the Tarain battles (Ghuri LOST the First, 1191; WON the Second, 1192); assuming all India fell when the south (Cholas, Kakatiyas, Hoysalas) and much of the north stayed free; reading the age as 'only war' when al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya, Ramanuja, Basava and great temples flourished; treating learning as one-way when al-Biruni studied India and Indian sine tables travelled outward; mislabelling terms (vimana=shrine tower, torana=gateway, vachana=Kannada poem, al-jabr=algebra/'reunion of broken parts', Mount Meru=cosmic mountain). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A timeline shows the Arab capture of Sindh in the early 8th century and the Turkic invasions of the 11th-12th centuries. Historians treat ONLY the later wave as the 'turning point' chiefly because it:

- (A) was the first time any outsider had ever set foot in India
- (B) pushed far deeper into the subcontinent and ultimately produced lasting foreign rule, unlike the earlier raids that stayed near Sindh
- (C) was a wholly peaceful trading wave rather than a military one
- (D) restored a single Gupta-style empire across the whole north

2. Two facts are given: the Arabs were largely confined near Sindh, while the Turkic invaders reached deep into the north. The single conclusion these BEST support is that what made the period a turning point was:

- (A) that both waves conquered the entire subcontinent equally
- (B) that neither the Arabs nor the Turks ever actually crossed into India
- (C) the depth of penetration, not merely the bare fact that an invasion occurred
- (D) that the southern Cholas had personally led both invasions

3. The chapter frames the age as one of 'resilience.' The single piece of evidence that best PROVES resilience, rather than mere survival, is that:

- (A) even while the north faced invasions, scholars, thinker-saints and temple-builders kept producing major new work
- (B) every Indian kingdom was levelled and then rebuilt identically
- (C) the invaders left India once and for all and never came back
- (D) all learning and building paused until the invasions had ended

4. Invaders kept entering India by the north-western passes such as the Khyber rather than by sea. The best explanation grounded in the chapter is that:

- (A) India had no coastline at all during this period
- (B) the passes were Chola naval bases that welcomed every invader
- (C) the southern kingdoms had no wealth worth invading
- (D) the north-west mountain passes were long-used overland routes, so the region became a recurring gateway for trade and invasion

5. Had the north-western passes been sealed, impassable mountains, the chapter's own logic implies that:

- (A) Mahmud of Ghazni would instead have come to rule all of India
- (B) the overland Turkic invaders would have found it far harder to enter India again and again
- (C) the Cholas would have lost their navy in the south
- (D) al-Biruni could never have learned Sanskrit

6. Calling the north-west India's 'recurring gateway' rather than its 'safest frontier' reflects the judgement that the region was:

- (A) sealed off by sea and therefore never breached
- (B) a southern port that faced no invaders at all
- (C) the frontier that protected India better than any other
- (D) repeatedly the point through which invaders entered, hence a vulnerability rather than a shield

7. The Hindu Shahis appear in the story of the EARLY Turkic invasions chiefly because they:

- (A) ruled the Tamil south and built the Brihadishvara temple
- (B) tried to guard the north-western approaches against the first wave of Turkic invaders

- (C) founded the Delhi Sultanate after the Battles of Tarain
- (D) led naval expeditions across the sea to Srivijaya

8. Mahmud of Ghazni led roughly 17 expeditions into India, yet the chapter denies that he 'ruled' India. The decisive reason is that:

- (A) he was defeated every single time and never actually reached India
- (B) he ruled only the south while the entire north stayed free
- (C) he founded the Delhi Sultanate and then governed it for life
- (D) after each raid he carried off plunder and withdrew, never staying to govern the land

9. A pupil writes, 'Mahmud of Ghazni destroyed the Brihadishvara temple in his raids.' The correct correction is that:

- (A) Mahmud destroyed Angkor Wat, which is just another name for Brihadishvara
- (B) Mahmud's famous raid targeted Somnath; Brihadishvara was a Chola temple of Rajaraja I in the far south, beyond his reach
- (C) the statement is correct exactly as written
- (D) Mahmud destroyed Nalanda, which is the same building as Brihadishvara

10. The word 'plunder' captures Mahmud's aim better than 'conquest' because plunder means:

- (A) land that is permanently annexed and then governed
- (B) a peace treaty signed between two rival kings
- (C) valuable goods seized by force in a raid, after which the raider departs
- (D) the towering shrine built over a temple's inner sanctum

11. If we judged Mahmud only by the immense treasure he carried home to Ghazni, we might wrongly conclude that he:

- (A) must have ruled India, when in fact wealth from raids does not require holding any territory
- (B) never actually entered India at all
- (C) had personally built the temples he visited
- (D) had commanded the Chola navy across the seas

12. Which statement most precisely contrasts a 'raider' with a 'conqueror' as the chapter uses the terms?

- (A) a raider always builds a lasting empire, while a conqueror never keeps any land
- (B) a raider takes treasure and leaves, while a conqueror stays to rule the land he takes
- (C) the two words mean exactly the same thing
- (D) a conqueror only loots temples while a raider governs villages

13. Mahmud repeatedly raided India but always returned to a base outside it. That base, from which his dynasty took its name, was:

- (A) Delhi, where he set up a permanent sultanate
- (B) Ghazni, in the lands to the north-west of India
- (C) Kannauj, the great city of the northern plain
- (D) Srivijaya, across the sea in Southeast Asia

14. A debater says, 'Mahmud and the Ghurids were really the same kind of force.' The single fact that best refutes this is that:

- (A) Mahmud reached India while the Ghurids never managed to cross the passes
- (B) the Ghurids only raided once and then left, while Mahmud governed for centuries
- (C) the Ghurids were a southern dynasty that had absorbed the Cholas
- (D) Mahmud withdrew with his loot after each raid, while the Ghurids stayed on to govern after their victory

15. The phrase 'from plunder to rule' best summarises the shift in which:

- (A) later invaders, unlike Mahmud, stayed to govern instead of merely looting and leaving
- (B) rulers gave up governing in order to take up raiding
- (C) the Cholas turned from a sea power into a band of land raiders
- (D) the Hindu Shahis began plundering the city of Ghazni

16. Why does the chapter credit the Ghurids, not Mahmud of Ghazni, with beginning lasting foreign rule in north India?

- (A) Mahmud reached India but the Ghurids never did
- (B) Mahmud governed for centuries while the Ghurids raided only once
- (C) the Ghurids and their generals stayed to govern after victory, whereas Mahmud always withdrew with his loot
- (D) the Ghurids absorbed the Cholas and ruled India from the south

17. Place in correct order, earliest first: (i) the Ghurids establish lasting rule in the north; (ii) Mahmud of Ghazni's plundering raids; (iii) Aibak founds the Delhi Sultanate. The correct sequence is:

- (A) the Ghurids' rule, then Mahmud's raids, then Aibak's Sultanate
- (B) Aibak's Sultanate, then Mahmud's raids, then the Ghurids' rule
- (C) Mahmud's raids, then Aibak's Sultanate, then the Ghurids' rule
- (D) Mahmud's raids, then the Ghurids' lasting rule, then Aibak's Delhi Sultanate

18. A claim runs: 'Because Mahmud's raids and the Ghurid conquest both involved force, they had the same long-term result.' The best correction is that:

- (A) both equally led to a lasting north-Indian sultanate
- (B) neither had any lasting result, since both forces left at once
- (C) only the Ghurid conquest led to lasting rule and a sultanate, while Mahmud's raids left no government behind
- (D) Mahmud's raids led to the sultanate while the Ghurids merely looted

19. Suppose a student lists Mahmud of Ghazni among the founders of the Delhi Sultanate. The single best reason this is an error is that:

- (A) the Sultanate was founded by Aibak, a Ghurid general, generations after Mahmud's loot-and-leave raids
- (B) Mahmud never reached India and so could found nothing there
- (C) the Delhi Sultanate was actually founded by the Hindu Shahis
- (D) the Delhi Sultanate was a southern kingdom built by the Cholas

20. Al-Biruni learning Sanskrit and writing a careful study of India is offered above all as proof that:

- (A) foreign scholars learned nothing whatever from India
- (B) all Indian learning had completely stopped during the invasions
- (C) serious scholarship and curiosity about India continued, and flowed both ways, even amid the invasions
- (D) books were no longer being written anywhere in this period

21. A debater claims, 'Al-Biruni came with the armies, so his book on India was just war propaganda.' The strongest counter from the chapter is that he:

- (A) never actually wrote anything about India
- (B) refused to study any Indian subject at all
- (C) personally led the destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila
- (D) learned Sanskrit and wrote a careful, serious study of India's sciences, religion and customs

22. Which pair of facts together best demonstrates the 'two-way' part of the period's learning?

- (A) al-Biruni studied India's sciences, while Indian sine tables travelled outward to influence mathematics elsewhere
- (B) al-Biruni destroyed Indian books, while Indians copied foreign ones
- (C) only India learned, taking everything from foreign scholars
- (D) no exchange of any knowledge took place in either direction

23. Indian sine tables travelling outward to shape mathematics beyond India matters chiefly because it shows that India was:

- (A) a giver, not only a receiver, of knowledge in this period
- (B) entirely without any mathematics of its own
- (C) always borrowing and never contributing any ideas
- (D) a place whose knowledge never once left the subcontinent

24. The word 'algebra' comes from the Arabic 'al-jabr.' The correct statement about this term is that it:

- (A) means 'reunion of broken parts' and comes from the title of al-Khwarizmi's book
- (B) means 'the cosmic mountain' represented at Angkor Wat

- (C) means 'a fleet of fighting ships' like the Chola navy
- (D) is the Kannada word for a short devotional poem

25. Trigonometry was vital to the astronomy of this age because it is the mathematics of:

- (A) decorative temple gateways and their carvings
- (B) warships and the sailors who crew them
- (C) triangles and angles, which astronomers used to measure positions in the sky
- (D) short Kannada poems used by the thinker-saints

26. That an Arabic-named subject (algebra, from al-jabr) and an Indian export (sine tables) both appear in the chapter best illustrates that mathematics in this age was:

- (A) invented solely in India with no outside contact
- (B) an international enterprise, with ideas and names crossing between cultures
- (C) developed only by Turkic generals while on campaign
- (D) abandoned everywhere until the invasions had ended

27. Bhaskaracharya flourishing as a mathematician-astronomer during this period is best used as evidence for the claim that:

- (A) Indian science was entirely a foreign invention
- (B) Indian mathematics vanished until the Cholas later revived it
- (C) science was practised only in the regions Mahmud had raided
- (D) Indian science endured and kept advancing despite the northern invasions

28. The Kakatiyas of the Deccan are specifically linked to the torana at Warangal. A 'torana' is best understood as:

- (A) the tall tower built over a temple's main shrine
- (B) a village assembly that governed local affairs
- (C) a subordinate ruler who owed loyalty to a king
- (D) a decorative stone gateway, a piece of monumental art

29. The Kakatiyas building a torana at Warangal and the Hoysalas flourishing in the Deccan together best prove that:

- (A) the whole of India had fallen to the Turkic invaders
- (B) the Deccan was governed directly from Ghazni
- (C) while the north faced invasions, the south remained free and went on creating great works
- (D) the south had no kingdoms of its own

30. Grouping the Kakatiyas, Hoysalas and Cholas together, the single feature all three share in this chapter is that they were:

- (A) Turkic dynasties that entered through the north-west passes
- (B) founders of the Delhi Sultanate after the Battles of Tarain

(C) Central Asian raiders allied with Mahmud of Ghazni

(D) southern or Deccan Indian powers that flourished while the north faced invasions

31. The Paramaras are tied to a ruler the chapter calls a 'scholar-king.' Calling Bhoja a scholar-king rather than simply a king stresses that he:

(A) never held any throne or governed any land

(B) actively championed learning alongside the work of ruling

(C) was a foreign invader rather than an Indian ruler

(D) commanded the Chola navy instead of leading an army

32. Rajaraja Chola I and Rajendra Chola I are remembered together because both:

(A) strengthened Chola power, including its navy, and extended the dynasty's reach

(B) raided Somnath and withdrew with the plunder

(C) were defeated at the Battles of Tarain

(D) founded Buddhist universities like Nalanda

33. Rajendra Chola I's naval expedition to Srivijaya is significant in this chapter mainly because, while the north faced invasions, it showed the south to be:

(A) a far-reaching sea power projecting strength across the Indian Ocean

(B) a landlocked region dependent on the northern passes

(C) a vassal forced to serve the Ghurid generals

(D) unaware of any lands beyond its own coast

34. The soaring vimana of the Brihadishvara temple, built under Rajaraja Chola I, is best read as evidence that:

(A) the Cholas built temples only after the Delhi Sultanate had fallen

(B) Mahmud of Ghazni had sponsored the Cholas' temple-building

(C) the south had given up temple construction by this age

(D) monumental temple architecture flourished in the free south during this period

35. Which statement correctly distinguishes a 'navy' from a 'vimana'?

(A) a navy is a temple tower, while a vimana is a fleet of ships

(B) both terms mean the same decorative gateway

(C) a navy is a country's fighting ships and crews, while a vimana is the tower over a temple's shrine

(D) a navy is a Kannada poem, while a vimana is a village assembly

36. The Cholas' control of the sea set beside Mahmud's overland raids best illustrates that, in this period, India's power was:

(A) concentrated entirely in Ghazni in the north-west

(B) wholly maritime, with no land kingdoms anywhere

- (C) split between flourishing maritime southern kingdoms and a north repeatedly raided by overland invaders
- (D) limited to the Hindu Shahis of the north-western frontier

37. Arrange these from earliest to latest: (i) the Second Battle of Tarain; (ii) Mahmud of Ghazni's raids; (iii) the First Battle of Tarain. The correct order is:

- (A) the First Battle of Tarain, then Mahmud's raids, then the Second Battle of Tarain
- (B) the Second Battle of Tarain, then the First Battle of Tarain, then Mahmud's raids
- (C) Mahmud's raids, then the Second Battle of Tarain, then the First Battle of Tarain
- (D) Mahmud's raids, then the First Battle of Tarain, then the Second Battle of Tarain

38. At the First Battle of Tarain (1191) the outcome for Muhammad Ghuri was that he:

- (A) defeated Prithviraj Chauhan and at once conquered all of India
- (B) was killed, ending the Ghurid threat for good
- (C) was defeated by Prithviraj Chauhan, only to return and win the following year
- (D) was carried to victory by the Chola navy

39. The Second Battle of Tarain (1192) is treated as a hinge of the period because Muhammad Ghuri's victory there:

- (A) ended in his defeat and permanent retreat from India
- (B) opened the way to lasting foreign rule, soon formalised in the Delhi Sultanate
- (C) destroyed the Chola navy in the southern seas
- (D) led directly back to Mahmud of Ghazni's first raid

40. Reversing the two Battles of Tarain in one's memory matters because it would wrongly imply that:

- (A) Mahmud of Ghazni had personally fought at Tarain
- (B) Prithviraj's resistance failed first in 1191 and then succeeded in 1192, hiding the real path to Ghurid rule
- (C) the Cholas had decided the outcome of both battles
- (D) the battles took place before the Arabs ever reached Sindh

41. Qutb-ud-din Aibak's role is best summarised as that of:

- (A) a Chola admiral who sailed across the sea to Srivijaya
- (B) a Ghurid general who, after the conquest, founded the Delhi Sultanate
- (C) the scholar who wrote a careful study of India
- (D) the saint who founded the Lingayat movement

42. Pairing Aibak with Bakhtiyar Khilji, the chapter uses them to show the two faces of the conquest, namely that it:

- (A) left both governance and learning entirely unchanged
- (B) only raided for treasure and never governed anything

- (C) built new political rule (the Sultanate) while also destroying old centres of learning (the universities)
- (D) served the Cholas and helped expand their navy

43. The destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila is described as especially damaging because these were:

- (A) great centres of learning - Buddhist universities - so their loss struck at knowledge itself
- (B) Chola naval bases guarding the southern coast
- (C) Turkic frontier forts in the north-west passes
- (D) Tamil trading ports on the Coromandel coast

44. A student matches the destruction of Nalanda and Vikramashila to Mahmud of Ghazni. The correct fix is that this destruction was the work of:

- (A) Bakhtiyar Khilji, a general of the later Ghurid conquest, not Mahmud of Ghazni
- (B) Rajaraja Chola I, who also built the Brihadishvara temple
- (C) al-Biruni, the scholar who studied India
- (D) the Hindu Shahis, who guarded the north-west

45. Ramanujacharya's philosophy, Vishishtadvaita, is best summarised as the teaching that:

- (A) the world and individual souls are real, with bhakti and surrender to God as the path to liberation
- (B) the world is wholly unreal and must be denied
- (C) ritual sacrifice by itself sets the soul free
- (D) there are no gods of any kind

46. Basavanna's Lingayat movement rejected caste and ritual. The institution he set up to embody this openness was the:

- (A) Delhi Sultanate, the seat of a sultan's rule
- (B) torana, a decorative ceremonial gateway
- (C) Chola navy, a fleet open to all recruits
- (D) Anubhava mandapa, a hall where people of all backgrounds met to exchange ideas

47. A 'vachana,' the form Basavanna used to spread his message, is:

- (A) the towering shrine of a South Indian temple
- (B) a short Kannada poem expressing spiritual and ethical ideas
- (C) a fleet of fighting ships
- (D) a decorative stone gateway

48. That the Lingayats welcomed all to the Anubhava mandapa while rejecting caste shows the movement valued, above all:

- (A) equality and the open exchange of ideas across social backgrounds
- (B) a strict caste hierarchy in worship
- (C) the supremacy of a single sultan over all
- (D) the military conquest of the south

49. Ramanuja's bhakti teaching and Basava's Lingayat movement are placed together in the chapter mainly to show that this age:

- (A) produced no religious thought of any kind
- (B) was occupied only by war and destruction
- (C) saw all spiritual life replaced by foreign rule
- (D) produced influential new religious thinkers and devotional movements even amid the invasions

50. Khajuraho and Brihadishvara are cited side by side to argue that, in this period, India was:

- (A) wholly given over to warfare with no building at all
- (B) ruled in every region from Ghazni
- (C) stripped of all artistic activity
- (D) rich in temple art and architecture across different regions

51. Angkor Wat in Cambodia is brought into a chapter on India because its five towers symbolise Mount Meru, which shows that:

- (A) India had conquered and ruled Cambodia by force
- (B) Indian cultural and religious ideas spread peacefully far beyond India's borders
- (C) Cambodia had invaded and ruled India
- (D) India possessed no temples of its own in this age

52. The five towers of Angkor Wat are said to represent Mount Meru, which is:

- (A) a fortress built by Mahmud of Ghazni
- (B) the largest of the Chola warships
- (C) the cosmic mountain at the centre of the universe in Indian cosmology
- (D) a Buddhist university like Nalanda

53. The grand temples within India together with India's influence on Angkor Wat best support the conclusion that the period's India was:

- (A) artistically barren and culturally isolated
- (B) a thriving cultural centre whose art and ideas radiated well beyond its borders
- (C) entirely ruled by the invaders in every region
- (D) a place where temple-building had been forbidden

54. Which statement correctly distinguishes a 'vimana' from a 'torana'?

- (A) a vimana is a gateway, while a torana is the shrine tower
- (B) both are types of warship
- (C) a vimana is the tower over a temple's main shrine, while a torana is a decorative gateway
- (D) a vimana is a Kannada poem, while a torana is a sultan's realm

55. Which combination correctly pairs each figure with his defining action?

- (A) Mahmud founded the Sultanate; Ghuri only raided; Aibak sailed to Srivijaya
- (B) Mahmud raided for plunder; Muhammad Ghuri came to stay and rule; Aibak founded the Delhi Sultanate
- (C) Mahmud ruled the south; Ghuri built Angkor Wat; Aibak wrote on algebra
- (D) Mahmud led the Chola navy; Ghuri destroyed Nalanda; Aibak defended the Khyber Pass

56. In a list of southern and Deccan powers that stayed free in this period, which name is the ODD ONE OUT?

- (A) the Ghurids
- (B) the Cholas
- (C) the Kakatiyas
- (D) the Hoysalas

57. A textbook caption pairs al-Biruni's careful study of India with Bhaskaracharya's mathematics. Taken together, this pairing best refutes the single misconception that:

- (A) India had ever possessed any mathematics at all
- (B) the southern kingdoms had stayed free of the invaders
- (C) the Cholas had built a powerful navy
- (D) the invasions had brought serious scholarship in and about India to an end

58. A friend insists, 'The 11th-12th centuries were nothing but invasion and ruin.' The strongest single rebuttal draws on:

- (A) the fact that no invasions actually occurred
- (B) the claim that the south too was conquered and ruined
- (C) the scholars (al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya), thinker-saints (Ramanuja, Basava) and temples (Khajuraho, Brihadishvara, Angkor Wat's Indian influence) of the same age
- (D) the idea that all learning ceased until the 13th century

59. A pupil writes three claims: 'Mahmud ruled all India,' 'the whole subcontinent fell,' and 'nothing of value was created.' How many are correct, and what is the best single correction?

- (A) none are correct: Mahmud only raided, much of India stayed free, and the age produced great scholars, saints and temples
- (B) all three are correct exactly as written
- (C) only the first is wrong; the other two are correct
- (D) only the third is wrong; Mahmud did rule all of India

60. Taking the chapter as a whole, the single statement that best captures the meaning of its title, 'Turning Tides,' is that this period:

- (A) saw the whole subcontinent fall under one foreign throne while culture died out
- (B) saw no real change at all from the centuries before it
- (C) saw invasions shift from passing raids to lasting rule in the north, even as the free south and a flowering culture carried India forward
- (D) saw India conquer and rule the lands to its north-west and across the sea

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 16: Turning Tides: 11th and 12th Centuries — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	B	11	A	21	D	31	B	41	B	51	B
2	C	12	B	22	A	32	A	42	C	52	C
3	A	13	B	23	A	33	A	43	A	53	B
4	D	14	D	24	A	34	D	44	A	54	C
5	B	15	A	25	C	35	C	45	A	55	B
6	D	16	C	26	B	36	C	46	D	56	A
7	B	17	D	27	D	37	D	47	B	57	D
8	D	18	C	28	D	38	C	48	A	58	C
9	B	19	A	29	C	39	B	49	D	59	A
10	C	20	C	30	D	40	B	50	D	60	C

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (B) The Arabs had already reached Sindh, so the Turkic wave was not the 'first' arrival; what set it apart was reaching deep into the north and finally giving lasting rule (the Ghurids, then the Delhi Sultanate). It was a military invasion, not peaceful trade, and no Gupta empire was restored, since the Guptas were long gone.

2. (C) Both waves were invasions, so the difference lay in how far they reached: the Turks went deep while the Arabs stayed near Sindh. Neither wave conquered the whole subcontinent (the south stayed free), both did cross into India, and the Cholas were a southern Indian sea power, not invaders.

3. (A) Resilience means continuing to flourish, shown by new scholarship, philosophy and temple art DURING the invasions. Kingdoms were not all levelled, the invaders returned repeatedly, and a pause in learning would be the opposite of resilience.

4. (D) The Khyber and similar passes were established overland routes, making the north-west the recurring entry point. India had a long coast (the Cholas were a sea power), the

passes were mountain routes rather than Chola bases, and the south had wealthy kingdoms it simply was not reached by these overland invaders.

5. (B) Since the passes were the gateway for overland invaders, closing them would have made repeated entry much harder. Mahmud raided rather than ruled regardless of the passes, the Chola navy was a southern sea matter unaffected by northern passes, and al-Biruni's Sanskrit study did not depend on the passes.

6. (D) A gateway invaders keep using is a weak point, not a safe one. The north-west was a land frontier rather than sea-sealed, it lay in the north rather than being a southern port, and far from protecting India best it was the very route invaders exploited.

7. (B) The Hindu Shahis defended the north-western frontier the passes opened up. The Tamil south and Brihadishvara belonged to the Cholas, the Sultanate was founded later by Aibak, and the Srivijaya voyage was Rajendra Chola's.

8. (D) Ruling means staying to govern; Mahmud instead seized loot and returned to Ghazni after each raid. He did reach India repeatedly and was not always defeated, he ruled neither north nor south, and the Delhi Sultanate was founded later by Aibak, a Ghurid general.

9. (B) Mahmud's notorious sack was of Somnath, while Brihadishvara was Rajaraja Chola's temple in the south, untouched by him. Angkor Wat is a Cambodian temple, the original claim is false, and Nalanda was a Buddhist university (later destroyed by Bakhtiyar Khilji), not Brihadishvara.

10. (C) Plunder is loot grabbed by force, with the raider then leaving, which matches Mahmud exactly, unlike conquest, which means keeping and governing land. A treaty is an agreement, and the tower over a sanctum is a vimana, an unrelated term.

11. (A) Great loot can tempt one to assume rule, but raiders gather wealth and leave without holding land, so the treasure alone does not prove rule, and he did not rule. He clearly entered India many times, he sacked rather than built temples, and he had no link to the Chola navy.

12. (B) The core difference is leaving versus staying-to-rule: raiders carry off loot and withdraw, conquerors keep and govern. A raider does not build an empire (that is the very distinction), the words are not synonyms, and the last option simply scrambles the roles.

13. (B) Mahmud ruled from Ghazni and returned there with his loot, which is exactly why he is called 'of Ghazni' and never ruled India. Delhi's sultanate came later under Aibak, Kannauj was an Indian city he did not rule from, and Srivijaya was the distant destination of Rajendra Chola's fleet.

14. (D) The dividing line is leaving versus staying: Mahmud raided and withdrew, the Ghurids stayed to rule (Aibak's Sultanate followed). Both reached India, Mahmud did not govern for centuries, and the Ghurids came through the north-west and did not absorb the southern Cholas.

15. (A) 'From plunder to rule' marks the move from Mahmud's loot-and-leave raiding to the Ghurids' staying-to-govern. It is not a shift from ruling to raiding, the Cholas remained a sea power, and the Hindu Shahis defended the frontier rather than plundering Ghazni.

16. (C) Lasting rule began with the Ghurids because they stayed and governed, with Aibak's Sultanate following, unlike Mahmud who repeatedly withdrew. Both reached India, Mahmud did not govern, and the Ghurids came through the north-west, not from the south, and did not absorb the Cholas.

17. (D) Mahmud's raids came first (early 11th century), the Ghurids then won and stayed to rule (after 1192), and Aibak, a Ghurid general, then founded the Delhi Sultanate. The other orders put a Tarain-era event before Mahmud or place Aibak before the Ghurid victory that made his Sultanate possible.

18. (C) Force was common to both, but only the Ghurids stayed to govern, giving the Delhi Sultanate, while Mahmud left no government behind. Mahmud's raids did not create the sultanate, the Ghurids did not merely loot, and their conquest plainly did have a lasting result.

19. (A) Aibak, a Ghurid general, founded the Delhi Sultanate after the Ghurid victory, long after Mahmud's raids, so Mahmud cannot be among its founders. Mahmud did reach India (many times), the Hindu Shahis defended the frontier rather than founding the Sultanate, and the Cholas were a southern sea power, not its founders.

20. (C) Al-Biruni mastering Sanskrit to study Indian sciences, religion and customs shows learning continued and was two-way. This directly contradicts the claims that foreigners learned nothing, that Indian learning stopped, or that no books were written.

21. (D) Al-Biruni did the genuine scholarly work of learning Sanskrit and studying India carefully, the mark of real inquiry rather than propaganda. He certainly did write a study, did not refuse to study India, and the universities were destroyed by Bakhtiyar Khilji, not al-Biruni.

22. (A) Two-way learning needs flow in both directions: a foreigner studying India and Indian knowledge spreading abroad, exactly the given pairing. The other options describe destruction, one-way borrowing, or no exchange, none of which is two-way.

23. (A) Sine tables travelling out proves India exported knowledge as well as receiving it. India clearly had mathematics (Bhaskaracharya, the sine tables themselves), it did contribute rather than only borrow, and its knowledge plainly did leave the subcontinent.

- 24. (A)** 'Al-jabr' means 'reunion of broken parts,' from al-Khwarizmi's book, giving the word algebra. The cosmic mountain is Mount Meru, a fleet of ships is a navy, and a short Kannada devotional poem is a vachana, all unrelated terms.
- 25. (C)** Trigonometry deals with triangles and angles, the tools astronomers needed to chart the heavens. Gateways (toranas), warships (a navy) and Kannada poems (vachanas) are unrelated terms from other parts of the chapter.
- 26. (B)** An Arabic-named technique and an Indian export side by side show mathematics crossing cultures. It was not purely Indian and isolated, was not the work of generals, and was not abandoned, since Bhaskaracharya was advancing it.
- 27. (D)** A great Indian mathematician-astronomer working during the invasions shows Indian science endured and advanced, the chapter's resilience theme. His work was Indian rather than foreign, mathematics did not vanish, and science thrived in the free south too, not only in raided areas.
- 28. (D)** A torana is an ornamental gateway, like the one the Kakatiyas built at Warangal. The tower over a shrine is a vimana, a village assembly is a sabha, and a subordinate ruler is a samanta, distinct terms students may confuse.
- 29. (C)** Active southern dynasties building monuments show the south stayed free and creative even as the north was invaded. This refutes the ideas that all India fell, that the Deccan was Ghazni-ruled (Mahmud only raided and withdrew), or that the south lacked kingdoms, since the Kakatiyas and Hoysalas were exactly such kingdoms.
- 30. (D)** The Kakatiyas, Hoysalas and Cholas were all Indian powers of the south and Deccan that thrived in the period. None were Turkic invaders, none founded the Sultanate (Aibak did), and none were Central Asian allies of Mahmud.
- 31. (B)** The label 'scholar-king' marks Bhoja's pairing of ruling with a genuine love of learning. He did rule (so 'never held a throne' is wrong), he was an Indian Paramara king rather than a foreign invader, and he had no link to the Chola navy.
- 32. (A)** Rajaraja built Chola sea power and the Brihadishvara temple, and Rajendra extended Chola reach by sea, so together they show a flourishing southern dynasty. Neither raided Somnath (Mahmud did), neither fought at Tarain (Prithviraj and Ghuri did), and neither founded Nalanda.
- 33. (A)** Sailing all the way to Srivijaya in Southeast Asia shows the Cholas were a powerful maritime force reaching far overseas. They were not landlocked, not Ghurid vassals, and clearly aware of distant lands they could reach by sea.
- 34. (D)** A towering Chola temple shows grand architecture thriving in the independent south. The Cholas built it well before the Sultanate (which came later in the north),

Mahmud raided temples rather than sponsoring them, and the south was producing some of its greatest temples, not abandoning them.

35. (C) A navy is the war-fleet (the Cholas had a strong one), and a vimana is the tall tower over a South Indian temple's main shrine, as at Brihadishvara. The other options swap the two, conflate them with a gateway (torana), or mislabel them as a poem (vachana) and an assembly (sabha).

36. (C) The contrast shows two theatres: a strong maritime south and a north hit by overland raiders, so power was split. It was not concentrated in Ghazni (Mahmud withdrew there but did not rule India), not wholly maritime (many land kingdoms existed), and not limited to the Hindu Shahis.

37. (D) Mahmud's raids fall in the early 11th century, the First Battle of Tarain was 1191, and the Second was 1192. So the order is raids, then First, then Second. The other sequences put a Tarain battle before Mahmud or reverse the two battles (1192 cannot precede 1191).

38. (C) Ghuri lost the First Battle of Tarain (1191) to Prithviraj, then came back to win the Second (1192). He did not win or conquer all India in 1191, was not killed (he returned the next year), and the distant southern Cholas had no part in these northern land battles.

39. (B) Ghuri's win in 1192 broke Prithviraj's resistance and led to lasting Ghurid rule, soon the Delhi Sultanate under Aibak. He won rather than lost in 1192, the Chola navy was untouched by a northern land battle, and Mahmud's raids came long before 1192, not after.

40. (B) Reversing them would suggest Prithviraj failed first and then beat back the Ghurids, obscuring how the 1192 defeat opened the way to Ghurid rule. The reversal has nothing to do with Mahmud (a Ghaznavid, not a Tarain combatant), the Cholas, or the much earlier Arab arrival in Sindh.

41. (B) Aibak, Muhammad Ghuri's general, established the Delhi Sultanate, turning conquest into lasting rule. The Srivijaya voyage was Rajendra Chola's, the careful study of India was al-Biruni's, and the Lingayat movement was Basavanna's.

42. (C) Aibak founding the Sultanate and Bakhtiyar Khilji destroying the universities together show the conquest both created new rule and destroyed old learning. It did not leave things unchanged, it went beyond mere raiding to governance (unlike Mahmud), and it had nothing to do with serving the Cholas.

43. (A) Nalanda and Vikramashila were renowned Buddhist universities, so destroying them was a heavy blow to learning, the chapter's point about the cost of the invasions. They were not naval bases, frontier forts or trading ports.

44. (A) Bakhtiyar Khilji destroyed Nalanda and Vikramashila; Mahmud's famous target was instead Somnath. Rajaraja Chola built temples in the south rather than destroying universities, al-Biruni was a scholar of India, and the Hindu Shahis defended the frontier.

45. (A) Vishishtadvaita holds that the world and souls are real and that loving devotion (bhakti) and surrender lead to liberation. It does not call the world unreal, does not make ritual sacrifice the sole path, and does not deny the gods.

46. (D) Basavanna's Anubhava mandapa was a hall where people of every background could meet and share ideas, embodying his rejection of caste. The Delhi Sultanate was Aibak's political creation, a torana is a gateway, and the Chola navy is a war-fleet.

47. (B) A vachana is a short Kannada poem, used by Basavanna to share his message of devotion and equality. A temple's tower is a vimana, a fleet is a navy, and a gateway is a torana.

48. (A) Welcoming people of every background to share ideas, while rejecting caste, marks equality and open dialogue as the movement's core values. It did not uphold caste hierarchy, did not promote rule by a sultan, and was a spiritual-social movement rather than a campaign of conquest.

49. (D) Ramanuja and Basava demonstrate vibrant new religious thought during the period, part of the resilience theme. This refutes the claims that there was no religious thought, that the age was only war, or that spiritual life was simply replaced by foreign rule.

50. (D) Two great temple complexes from different regions show the period's flourishing temple art and architecture. This contradicts the ideas that there was only warfare and no building, that India was Ghazni-ruled (Mahmud only raided), or that art had ceased.

51. (B) Angkor Wat's towers evoking Mount Meru show Indian ideas reaching Cambodia through cultural influence, not conquest. India did not conquer Cambodia, Cambodia did not rule India, and India had many great temples of its own, such as Khajuraho and Brihadishvara.

52. (C) Mount Meru is the cosmic mountain of Indian cosmology, symbolised by Angkor Wat's five towers, evidence of India's cultural reach. It is not a Ghaznavid fortress, a Chola warship, or a university like Nalanda.

53. (B) Magnificent home temples plus influence abroad show India as a flourishing, outward-reaching cultural centre. It was neither barren nor isolated, was not ruled everywhere by invaders (the south stayed free), and certainly did not forbid temple-building.

54. (C) A vimana is the tall tower above a temple's main shrine (as at Brihadishvara), and a torana is an ornamental gateway (as at Warangal). The others swap them, call them warships, or mislabel them as a vachana (poem) and a sultanate (a sultan's realm).

55. (B) Mahmud raided and withdrew, the Ghurids (Muhammad Ghuri) came to govern, and Aibak founded the Delhi Sultanate, the only fully correct chain. The other options scramble deeds: Mahmud did not found the Sultanate or rule the south, Aibak did not sail to Srivijaya (Rajendra Chola did) or write on algebra, Ghuri did not build Angkor Wat or destroy Nalanda (Bakhtiyar Khilji did), and the Khyber was guarded by the Hindu Shahis.

56. (A) The Cholas, Kakatiyas and Hoysalas were all free southern or Deccan powers, while the Ghurids were the north-western invaders who came to rule the north, so they are the odd one out and do not belong in this group.

57. (D) A foreign scholar studying India (al-Biruni) and an Indian advancing mathematics (Bhaskaracharya) together prove scholarship continued, refuting the claim that learning had ended. They do not bear on whether India had mathematics (it clearly did), nor on the south's freedom or the Chola navy, which are separate, true facts the pairing does not deny.

58. (C) The age's scholars, thinker-saints and temples, all flourishing during the invasions, directly disprove 'nothing but ruin.' Invasions did occur, the south was not conquered but flourished, and learning did not cease, since al-Biruni, Bhaskaracharya and others were active throughout.

59. (A) All three claims are false: Mahmud merely raided (lasting rule came later under the Ghurids), much of the north and all the south stayed free, and the period was rich in scholarship, devotion and temple art. The other options accept one or more of these misconceptions, including the false notion that Mahmud ruled India, and so are wrong.

60. (C) The 'turning tide' is the move from raiding to lasting rule in the north, set against a free, flourishing south and a vigorous culture, the chapter's balanced picture. The subcontinent did not all fall and culture did not die, the period was a clear change from before, and India was the one invaded overland, not the conqueror of the north-west or overseas.